

The inherited record and the solo contribution

two columns at the Semester-3 boundary; every item is drawn from the repository's own provenance record

Semester 3 — inherited (group project)

Group 6: six students, guides A. R. Paduri and N. Darapaneni; the candidate was a member of that group.

Semester 4 — the candidate's own work

solo continuation under guide R. P. Guledgudd; the research direction, the experiments and the papers are the candidate's own.

23 April 2026 · the Semester-3 boundary

1 Research direction

A multi-framework benchmark: one post-training recipe run across libraries, so that the libraries themselves can be compared.

1 Research direction

A new direction of the candidate's own: measure when the group-relative signal vanishes, and establish what a stack-conditioned result must report before it can be attributed.

2 Repository and tooling

The multi-framework repository and its baseline integrations, the shared runtime code, and the Tinker, TRL, veRL and OpenRLHF adapters.

2 Repository and tooling

Instrumentation and analysis built on that code: new GRPO diagnostics and controllers, the reporting and registry work, and the Berkeley-course-inspired audits and prototypes.

3 Experiments and evidence

The initial Tinker, SkyRL and GRPO experiments, the group literature foundation, and the early benchmark and evaluation scaffolding.

3 Experiments and evidence

The post-capstone experiment and audit expansion: the scaling, ZVF, group-size, length-bias, fraud and statistical analyses, spanning 206 recorded analysis iterations.

4 Outputs and authorship

The Semester-3 record as the group left it, frozen on 23 April 2026 at the capstone tag.

4 Outputs and authorship

The eight standalone P1–P8 papers and their current authorship, the NeurIPS workshop variant, and this thesis and its figures.

Where the boundary is drawn

The boundary and the record

- Semester-3 tag `capstone-final-2026-04-25`; boundary commit `21a99ef7`, dated 23 April 2026.
- The post-capstone span holds 584 commits and 5,050 changed files, and the continuation adds 206 recorded analysis iterations.
- The split is recorded at paper level in commit `282e6b4f`, 7 July 2026.

How to read the two columns

- Left is what the group project produced; right is what the candidate added on top of it in Semester 4.
- The repository's own caveat: *“This distinction is about academic contribution. It does not duplicate or relocate the shared runtime code.”*
- The changed-file count measures activity, not academic contribution.